SETUP & USER GUIDE · V0.3.1

Novacura Buddy

A Chrome side panel that sits next to the Novacura Flow Designer. It watches which IFS Cloud projections you use, turns them into Flow Connect modules, records IFS traffic, deploys Quick Reports and Custom LUs, and builds modules from any OpenAPI description.

Projection Tracker | Traffic Recorder | Quick Reports | Custom LUs | API Modules | Basic Data

INSTALL THE EXTENSION.

Novacura Buddy is loaded as an unpacked extension. Install it once into a folder you keep; updates go into the same folder so your saved settings stay.

1. **Download the release zip**
   Get `NovacuraBuddy-vX.Y.Z.zip` from the repository's Releases page on GitHub (Brasijoe/NovacuraBuddy).

2. **Unzip it into a permanent folder**
   For example `C:\dev\NovacuraBuddy`. Do not leave it in Downloads: Chrome loads the extension from this folder every time it starts.

3. **Open `chrome://extensions` and switch on Developer mode**
   The switch is at the top right of the page.

4. **Click Load unpacked and pick the folder**
   The extension appears in the list as *IFS Projection Tracker*, version 0.3.1.

5. **Pin it and open the side panel**
   Click the puzzle icon in the toolbar, pin the extension, then click its icon. The side panel opens on the right and stays open while you switch tabs.

TIP The side panel needs Chrome 114 or later. Install into the same folder on every update so Chrome keeps your saved instances.

CONNECT AN IFS INSTANCE.

Everything that talks to IFS (projection search, module creation, Quick Report and Custom LU deploys) uses the instances you save on the Basic Data tab.

The quick way

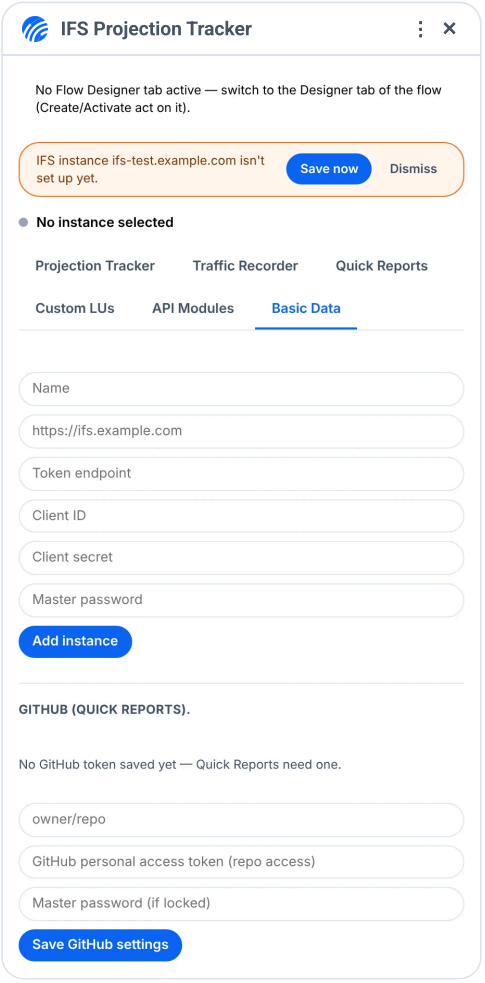
Open IFS Cloud in a browser tab and click around. When the panel sees traffic from an IFS host it doesn't know, it shows an orange banner: *"IFS instance ifs-test.example.com isn't set up yet."* Click **Save now** and the form on Basic Data is pre-filled with the name and base URL.

Fill in the form

Name	Any label, shown at the top of the panel (for example *IFS Test*).
Base URL	The IFS address, such as `https://ifs-test.example.com`.
Token endpoint	The OAuth token URL of the IFS IAM realm.
Client ID / secret	An IAM client with the client-credentials grant.
Master password	Your own password that encrypts the client secret in the browser. You set it with the first instance.

Click **Add instance**. Chrome asks once for permission to reach that site; allow it. The panel requests a token straight away, so a saved instance is a working instance.

Saved instances are listed at the top of Basic Data. Click a row to make it the current instance (its name appears in the header), and use **Test**, **Rename** and **Delete** on each row.



First start: the banner offers to save the IFS host it just saw.

CONNECT GITHUB.

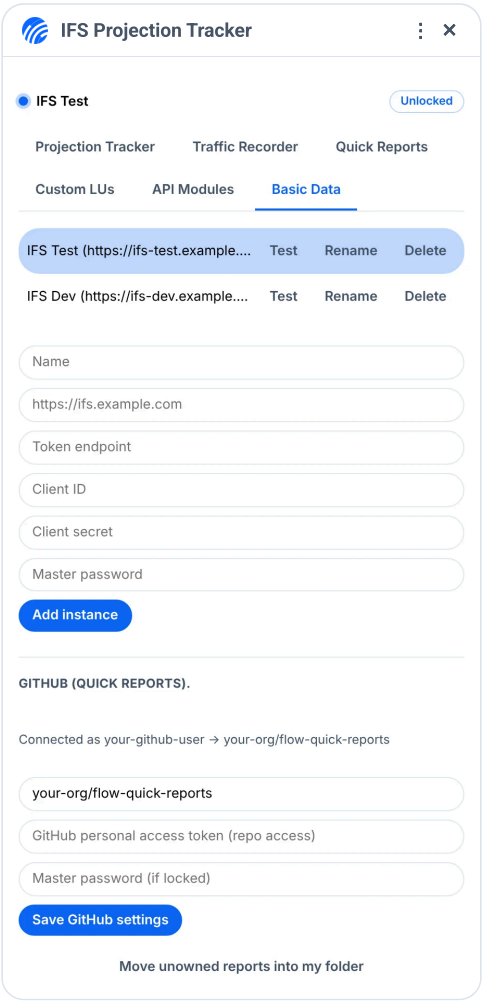
Quick Reports and the Custom LU library are stored as files in a GitHub repository, so your team shares one library and every change has history.

1. **Create a personal access token**
   On GitHub, a token with read and write access to the repository's contents.

2. **Enter the repository and token**
   Under *GitHub (Quick Reports)* on Basic Data, type `owner/repo` and the token, then **Save GitHub settings**.

3. **Check the status line**
   It reads *Connected as your-user → owner/repo*. The token is encrypted with the same master password.

Each user's reports are kept in their own folder in the repository. If you have reports from before per-user folders existed, **Move unowned reports into my folder** moves them once.



Basic Data with two instances and GitHub connected.

CONNECT THE FLOW DESIGNER.

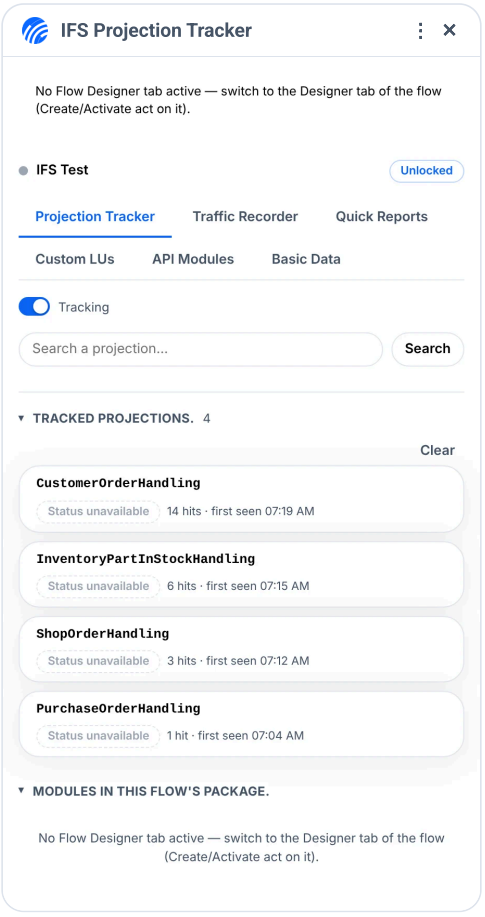
Buttons that create or activate modules act on the flow that is open in the Designer. There is no separate login: the panel reuses your Flow session.

1. **Open the flow in the Designer**
   Go to `build.novacura.com` and open the flow you're working on.

2. **Click once inside the Designer**
   The panel picks up your Flow session from the Designer's own requests. Until then you'll see *"Designer tab found, but no Flow session yet."*

3. **Keep that tab in front**
   The dot next to the instance name turns blue when the active tab is a Designer tab. Switch to another tab and Create/Activate turns off again, so a module never lands in the wrong flow.

The panel finds the flow's package from the Designer tab, so new modules go into the same package as the flow.



With no Designer tab in front, the panel says so and the module switches stay off.

PROJECTION TRACKER.

Use IFS as usual and the tracker lists every projection your screens call. Each one becomes a Flow Connect module with one switch.

Tracked projections

With **Tracking** on, each projection seen on the current instance appears with its hit count and when it was first seen. Technical projections that never make sense as modules are filtered out. **Clear** empties the list.

Looking for one you haven't clicked through? Type part of a name into *Search a projection…* and press **Search**; matches from IFS are added to the list.

The switch

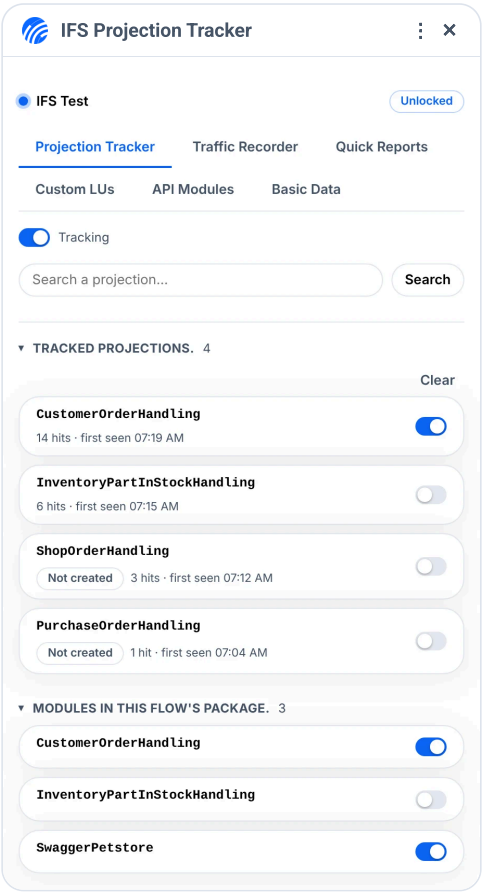
The switch on each row means *this module is active in the open flow*.

- **On** for a row marked *Not created*: the module is generated from the projection's metadata, saved into the flow's package and activated.
- **On** for an existing module: it is added to the flow.
- **Off**: the module is removed from the flow. The module itself stays in the package.

The Designer refreshes itself afterwards, so the module appears in the flow without reloading.

Modules in this flow's package

The second list shows every module already in the package, including ones built from API descriptions, with the same switches.



Two modules active, one created but not in this flow, two not created yet.

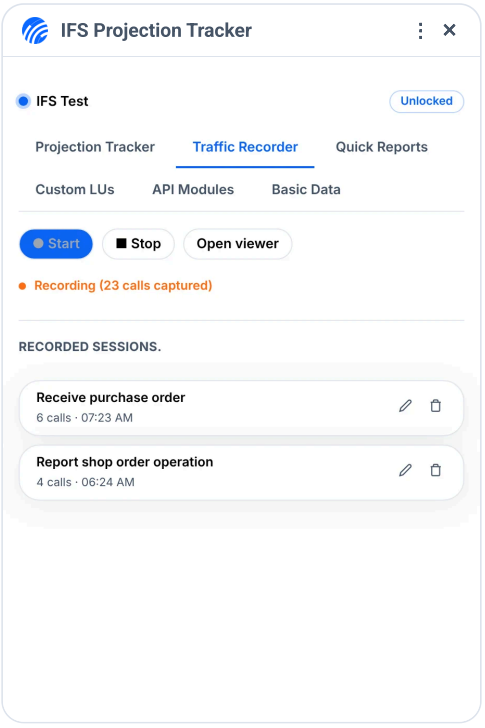
TRAFFIC RECORDER.

Record what IFS does while you walk through a process once, then turn those calls into Flow steps.

1. **Start**
   Click **● Start**, switch to IFS and do the process, for example receiving a purchase order. The status line counts the captured calls.

2. **Stop**
   Click **■ Stop**. The session is saved with a name you can change with the pencil icon.

3. **Open the viewer**
   Click a session or **Open viewer** to inspect it in a full tab.

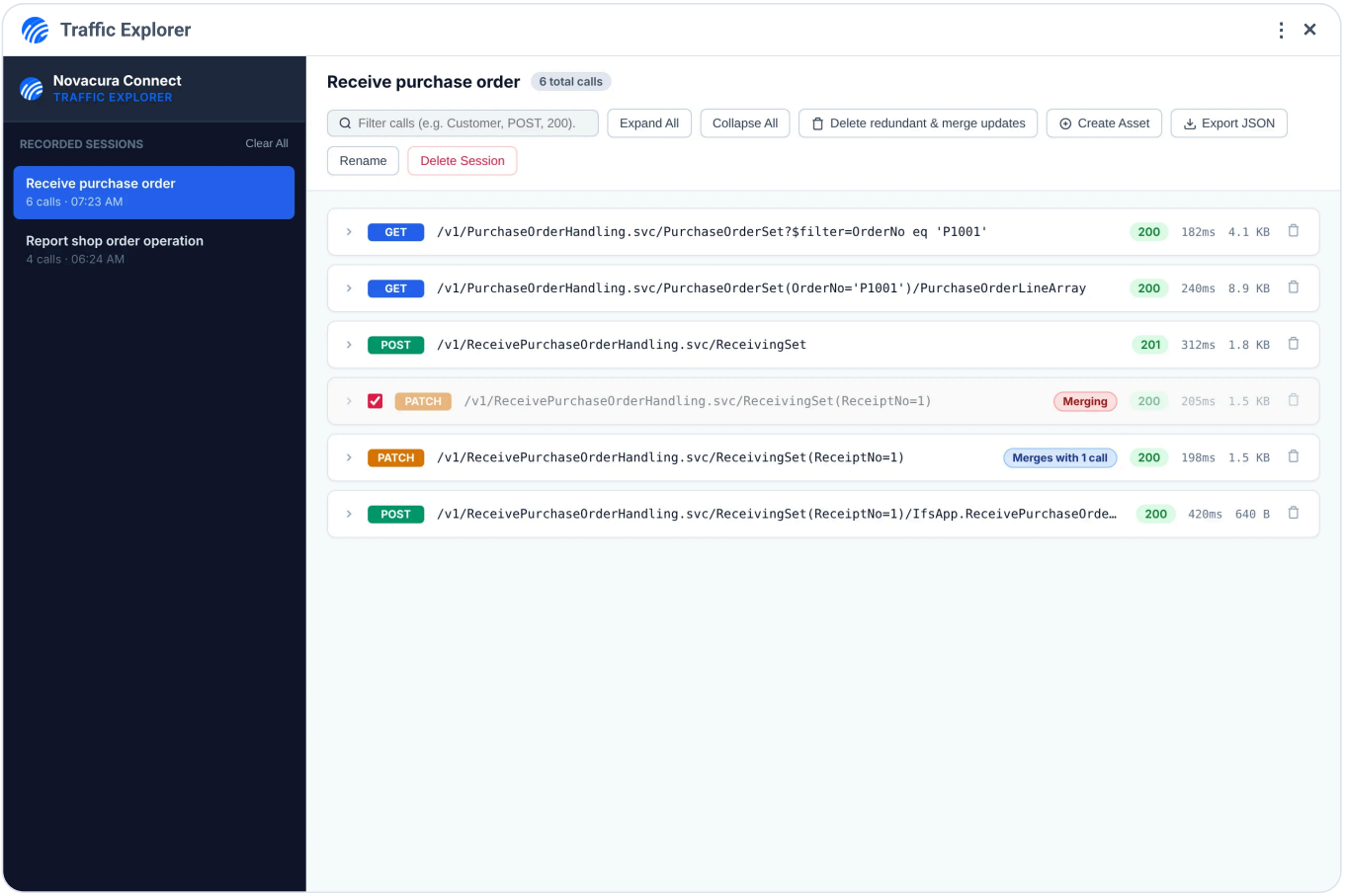


Recording in progress.

The Traffic Explorer

The viewer lists every call with method, endpoint, status, timing and size. Expand a call to see the request and response bodies, headers, and a ready-made cURL command.

- **Delete redundant & merge updates** marks duplicate and unused calls, and merges consecutive PATCH calls on the same record into one. Review the marks and confirm.
- **Create Asset** builds a Flow asset from the remaining calls in the package you choose, with the inputs and key references between steps worked out for you.
- **Export JSON** saves the session to a file.


Traffic Explorer
Novacura Connect
TRAFFIC EXPLORER
RECORDED SESSIONS
Clear All
Receive purchase order
6 calls · 07:23 AM
Report shop order operation
4 calls · 06:24 AM
Receive purchase order
6 total calls
Filter calls (e.g. Customer, POST, 200).
Expand All
Collapse All
Delete redundant & merge updates
Create Asset
Export JSON
Rename
Delete Session
GET /v1/PurchaseOrderHandling.svc/PurchaseOrderSet?$filter=OrderNo eq 'P1001' 200 182ms 4.1 KB
GET /v1/PurchaseOrderHandling.svc/PurchaseOrderSet(OrderNo='P1001')/PurchaseOrderLineArray 200 240ms 8.9 KB
POST /v1/ReceivePurchaseOrderHandling.svc/ReceivingSet 201 312ms 1.8 KB
PATCH /v1/ReceivePurchaseOrderHandling.svc/ReceivingSet(ReceiptNo=1) Merging 200 205ms 1.5 KB
PATCH /v1/ReceivePurchaseOrderHandling.svc/ReceivingSet(ReceiptNo=1) Merges with 1 call 200 198ms 1.5 KB
POST /v1/ReceivePurchaseOrderHandling.svc/ReceivingSet(ReceiptNo=1)/IfsApp.ReceivePurchaseOrde… 200 420ms 640 B

QUICK REPORTS.

Keep your SQL Quick Reports in one GitHub library, deploy them to any instance, and get a Flow module for each deployed report.

Find and write

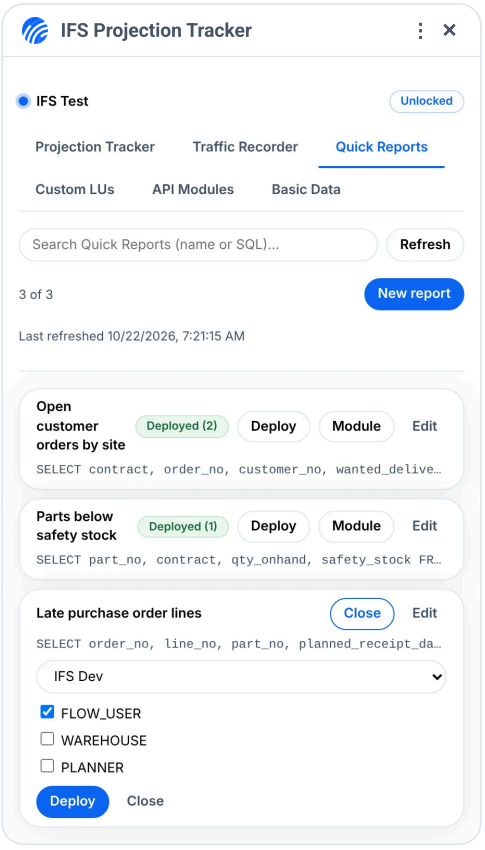
Search by name or by text in the SQL. **New report** and **Edit** open the editor in a tab, with Beautify, Save, and the deploy history per instance.

Deploy

Click **Deploy** on a report, choose the instance and tick the permission sets that should see it. The panel remembers your last choice per instance. If the report already exists there, you're asked before it is overwritten. The green *Deployed (n)* pill counts the instances it lives on.

Module

Once deployed, **Module** creates the Flow module for the report's projection and activates it in the open flow. With more than one deployment, pick which instance it should come from.



The deploy form for one report, with permission sets.

CUSTOM LUS.

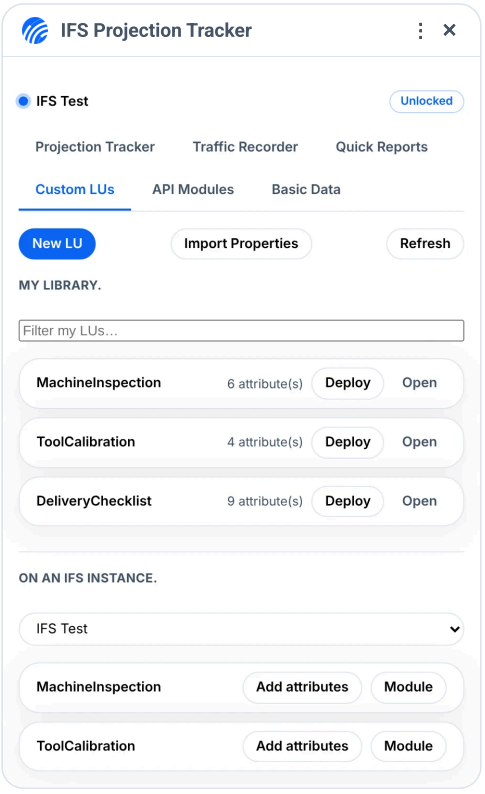
Design Custom Logical Units once, keep them in the library, and roll them out to each instance with one deploy.

My library

New LU opens the editor for a new LU and its attributes. **Import Properties** turns a Flow properties file (.json) into LU definitions. **Deploy** creates the LU and its new attributes on an instance, approves and publishes them, and grants the LU's projection to the permission sets you pick.

On an IFS instance

Choose an instance to list the Custom LUs that already exist there. **Add attributes** extends one, and **Module** creates the Flow module for its projection in the open flow.



Library on top, what's on IFS Test below.

API MODULES.

Turn any REST API with an OpenAPI 3.x or Swagger 2.0 description into a Flowscript module, ready to use in the flow.

1. Load the description

Paste the URL of an `openapi.json` or of a Swagger UI or Redoc page and press **Load**; the panel follows the docs page to the real description. You can also use **Use current tab**, **Upload file…** or **Paste…**. If the URL is on a saved IFS instance, its token is used.

2. Pick operations

Operations are grouped by tag. Tick what you need. List calls that return arrays are marked *Queryable*; they also become data sources you can `select … from … where …`.

3. Choose comments

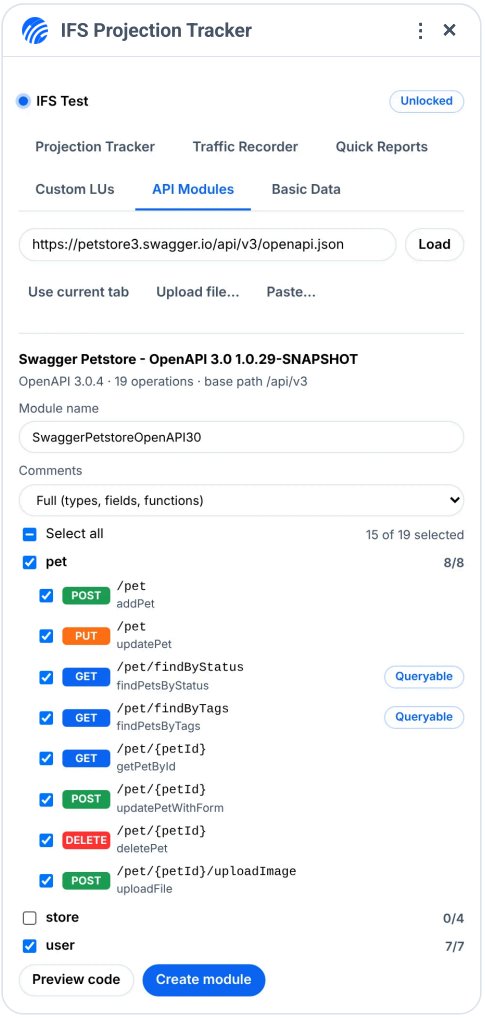
Full Descriptions, formats, allowed values, examples and errors from the spec on every type, field and function. Best for people and AI reading the module.

Short One line per function.

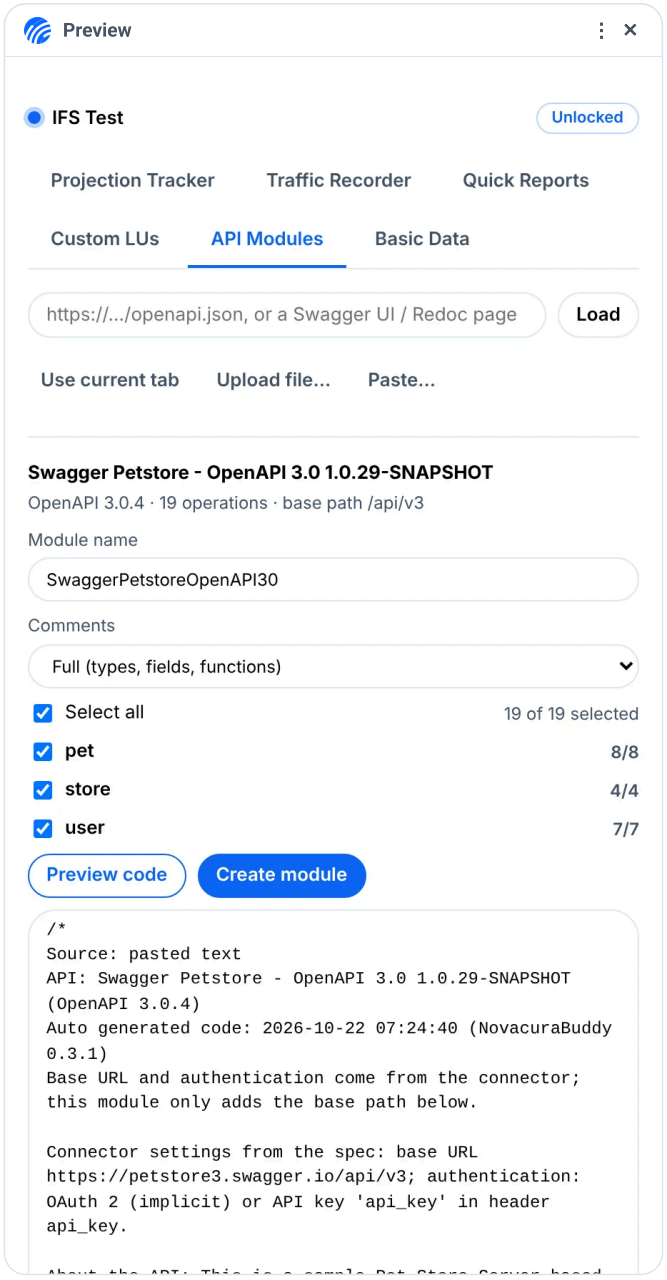
Off No comments.

4. Preview or create

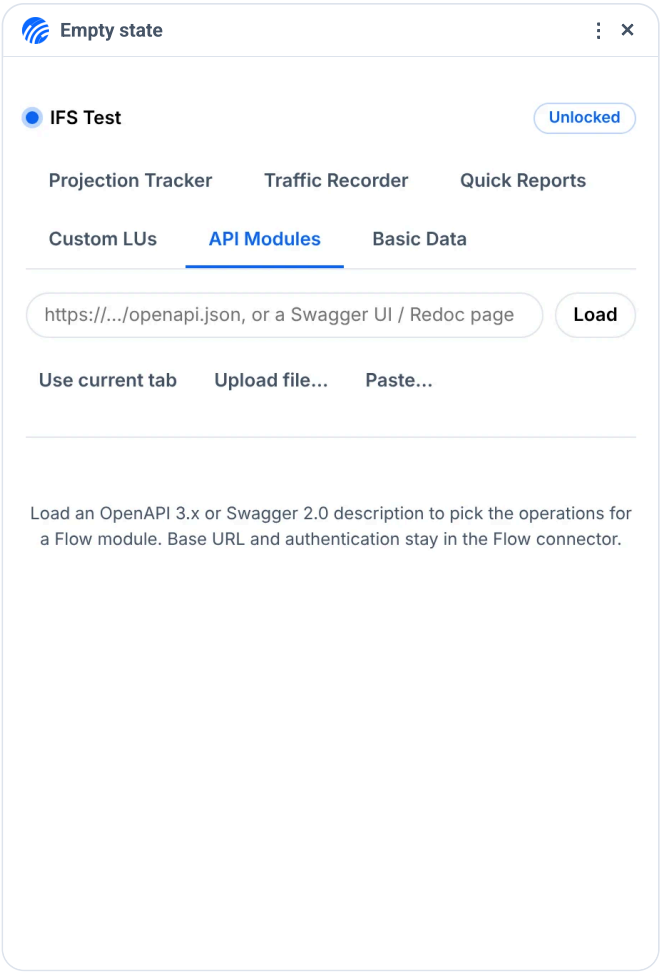
Preview code shows the generated Flowscript to copy. **Create module** saves it into the flow's package and activates it in the open flow. Base URL and authentication stay in the Flow connector, not in the module.



Swagger Petstore loaded: pet operations picked, store unticked.



Preview: the module header records the source, API version and connector settings.



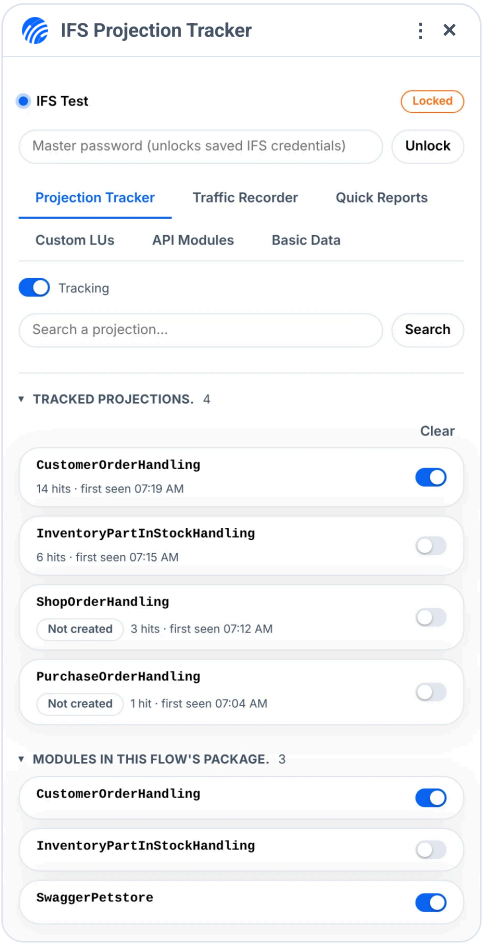
Before loading: four ways to bring in a description.

DAILY START.

Your IFS secrets and GitHub token are encrypted. After a browser restart or an extension reload they are locked again.

The header shows an orange *Locked* chip and an unlock field. Type the master password and press **Unlock** or Enter. The chip turns blue (*Unlocked*) and stays that way until the browser closes.

> **NOTE** The master password is not stored anywhere. If you forget it, delete the instances and add them again.



Locked after a restart.

UPDATING.

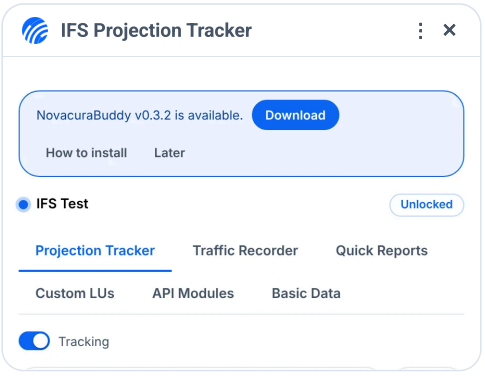
The panel checks GitHub for a new release when the extension starts or reloads, and when you open the panel if the last check is more than six hours old.

1. **Click Download in the banner**
   It saves `NovacuraBuddy-vX.Y.Z.zip`.

2. **Unzip over your existing folder**
   Replace the files in the same folder; that keeps your instances and settings. **How to install** links to the extension's details page, where *Source* shows the folder.

3. **Reload**
   On `chrome://extensions`, click the reload arrow on the extension, then unlock again.

Later hides the banner for that version.



The update banner (sample version).

TROUBLESHOOTING.

The panel explains itself in banners. These are the messages you'll meet most.

MESSAGE	WHAT TO DO
No Flow Designer tab active — switch to the Designer tab of the flow	Bring the Designer tab of the flow to the front. Create and Activate always act on the tab you're looking at.
Designer tab found, but no Flow session yet	Click anywhere inside the Designer once so it makes a request the panel can pick the session up from.
Saved credentials are locked	Enter the master password in the unlock field at the top of the panel.
IFS instance … isn't set up yet	Click **Save now** and complete the form on Basic Data, or **Dismiss** if you don't need that host.
Add a GitHub token in Basic Data to see your Quick Reports	Fill in *GitHub (Quick Reports)* on Basic Data.
The API description is at … Click Load once more to allow access to that site	The docs page points to a description on another site. Click **Load** again and allow Chrome's permission prompt.
A module named … already exists in this package	Confirm to replace its code with the newly generated module, or change the module name first.

Red error banners stay until you click them, so you can read them in full.
Screenshots in this guide use sample data from the real panel; instance names and hosts are placeholders.